

Thread - 2024-01-10

<https://x.com/RiikonenMarko/status/1745051170463228113>

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On 1 January was I on the lookout for halos but came back to apartment to eat. As I parked there was a little swarm with tangent arc and parhelia around the streetlights and the crystals immediately blanketed the car giving this display. We see a white arc to the left of the parhelion. I had encountered it on an earlier occasion this winter, but did not take documentation. There is also a white arc visible from the other side of the car, presumably it is the same thing.

Plates shouldn't do any such arc, so must be from Parry oriented crystals. The columns in the swarm may come to rest as Parry crystals on the even surface of the car roof. Helic arc, then? In a display on the previous day (<https://t.co/1kOR5VNpAq>) the white arc did not appear. Next time I need to do more proper studies in a light through the windshield. If Parry crystals are indeed the culprit, then transmitted light should reveal Parry arcs.

There maybe some differences between frost and precipitated crystal displays. Don't remember how the previous day display was formed. They are distinguished by just wiping the surface. However, given time, possibly the precipitated crystals can grow stuck on the surface and thus become indistinguishable from frost crystals.

[video: 1745051170463228113-tGHDv9l2RfcfGfgQ.mp4]
